

GLOBAL CODE OF CONDUCT & ETHICS POLICY

VERTEX CORP & CONTROLLED SUBSIDIARIES

Section 1: SCOPE AND GENERAL OBLIGATIONS

1.1 Applicability. This Policy applies to all full-time employees, part-time employees, officers, directors, and independent contractors of Vertex Corp worldwide. Every representative must review and sign this policy annually.

Section 2: ANTI-BRIBERY AND FCPA COMPLIANCE

2.1 Prohibited Payments. Vertex Corp has zero tolerance for bribery and corruption. In accordance with the U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA) and local laws, representatives are strictly prohibited from offering, paying, promising, or authorizing the payment of any money, gift, travel expense, or thing of value to any foreign official, political candidate, or government employee to influence an official act or secure an improper business advantage.

2.2 Accounting Standards. All transactions must be accurately recorded in the corporate books. Slush funds or off-book transactions are strictly illegal. Violation of anti-bribery policies will result in immediate termination and referral to law enforcement agencies.

Section 3: CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

3.1 Mandatory Disclosure. Employees must avoid situations where their personal interests conflict with Vertex Corp. Conflict situations include holding a financial stake in a vendor or competitor, or undertaking external employment. All potential conflicts must be disclosed in writing to the Compliance Officer (compliance@vertexcorp.com) for review and resolution.

Section 4: WHISTLEBLOWER PROTECTION AND NON-RETALIATION

4.1 Reporting Violations. Employees are encouraged to report any suspected compliance violations, financial fraud, or unethical behavior. Reports can be made anonymously through the secure compliance hotline (1-800-555-ETHX).

4.2 Non-Retaliation Policy. Vertex Corp maintains a strict non-retaliation policy. No employee shall be demoted, harassed, threatened, or penalized for making a report in good faith. Any retaliatory actions will face severe disciplinary consequences.